

OSINT 101

Source Evaluation Template

Admiralty-system source and intelligence reliability assessment

Open-Source Intelligence, Explained

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Admiralty System Rating Scale

Code	Source Reliability	Meaning
A	Reliable	No doubt about authenticity/trustworthiness
B	Usually Reliable	Minor reservations; history of accuracy
C	Fairly Reliable	Some doubt; history of occasional errors
D	Not Usually Reliable	Significant doubt; history of errors
E	Unreliable	Lacks authenticity / known to be deceptive
F	Cannot Be Judged	Insufficient data to evaluate

Code	Info Credibility	Meaning
1	Confirmed	Confirmed by independent sources
2	Probably True	Strong circumstantial evidence
3	Possibly True	Some supporting evidence
4	Doubtful	Contradictory or questionable
5	Improbable	Contradicted by reliable sources
6	Cannot Be Judged	No basis for evaluation

Source Evaluation Matrix

Admiralty Code Example: A-1 = Highly reliable source with confirmed information (gold standard). E-6 = Unreliable source with unverifiable information (discard).

Individual Source Evaluation

Source Profile

Source Name: _____

URL / Location: _____

Source Type: ☐ Social Media ☐ News ☐ Government ☐ Academic ☐ Corporate ☐ Forum ☐ Other

Reliability Assessment

Criterion	Rating	Notes
Reliability (A-F)		
Credibility (1-6)		
Admiralty Code		
Access Level		
Bias Assessment		
Corroboration Status		

Additional Notes

First encountered: _____ | Last verified: _____

Corroborating sources: _____

Contradicting sources: _____

Overall confidence: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High ☐ Near-certain

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